

When students have to evacuate Spain in two days, emotions run high

By Ysabelle Kempe
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

In Spain, staying up late is a rite of passage. It's a society enamored with the night, complete with shockingly late dinners and a nightclub culture that doesn't get going until 2 a.m.

But a week ago Thursday, in my Madrid apartment, a group of us studying abroad for the semester were sleepless at 5 a.m. for a much less enjoyable reason. President Trump had just announced there would be travel restrictions from most of Europe to the United States beginning in just two days.

The only thing that seemed certain at that point were the uncertainties, among them: What did it mean that we could return to the United States only after "appropriate testing"? And would our universities refund us for the flights home, which were already climbing past \$2,000?

As the dust settled the next day, I packed

MADRID, Page N14



BERNAT ARMANGUE/AP

A view of the Toledo bridge in Madrid during the COVID-19 lockdown.

cvd_457

Clipped By:
relianceenwerem
Mar 30, 2026